Free skin cancer education for New Jersey seniors, on every skin tone.

Every Shade is a student-run group at Rutgers University–New Brunswick. We teach older adults where skin cancer hides on darker skin, how to check their own skin once a month, and where to get a spot looked at for free.

66% vs 90%
five-year melanoma survival, Black vs white patients, largely because of later diagnosis (1)

46% vs 2%
of melanomas of a known type on the palms, soles, or under the nails, Black vs white patients (1)

15%
of images in common medical study resources show skin of color (2)

What we do

- **Free 45-minute talks** for senior centers, libraries, faith communities, senior housing, and community groups, in person or on Zoom
- **Large-print handout in 7 languages:** English, Spanish, Hindi, Urdu, Gujarati, Haitian Creole, Korean (native-speaker reviewed)
- **Free monthly self-check web app;** photos never leave the user's phone
- **Care finder:** free and sliding-fee clinics in all 21 NJ counties
- **Chapter toolkit** for students at other schools

How we work

- We teach; we never diagnose. Students help people find a clinician.
- Physician-reviewed content from the AAD, Skin Cancer Foundation, CDC, and peer-reviewed research
- Anonymous before-and-after quiz at every talk; results published
- Trained, certified student speakers
- No product endorsements; privacy first

First public talk: November 20, 2026. Every talk is measured with the same anonymous before-and-after quiz, and every result is published on our Impact page.

Book a talk or partner with us

Hosts: free, and we handle setup. Clinicians and faculty: join a talk, review content, or partner on a free skin-check day. Funders: printing and in-kind support reach seniors directly.

Contact

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(1) Culp MB, Lunsford NB. Melanoma among non-Hispanic Black Americans. Prev Chronic Dis. 2019;16:180640. (2) Perlman KL, et al. Skin of color lacks representation in medical student resources. Int J Womens Dermatol. 2021;7(2):195-196. Every Shade provides general health education only, not medical advice.